PHYS 120 Physics of Everyday Life: Syllabus (Fall 2026)

4 credits · Instructor: Prof. B. Sample · Lectures Tuesdays 14:00

Assessment

Component	Weight	Due
Problem sets 1-3	15% (5% each)	done
Problem set 4	5%	Mon 9 Nov, 23:59
Problem set 5	5%	Mon 16 Nov, 23:59
Midterm	25%	Thu 15 Oct
Lab report 1	10%	Fri 16 Oct
Lab report 2		Fri 13 Nov, 17:00
Lab safety quiz	Pass/fail	Tue 3 Nov, 12:00
Final exam	30%	Tue 1 Dec, 14:00

The final exam covers Lectures 1 to 8.
You must pass the lab safety quiz before you can attend any lab session.

Lecture schedule

Lecture	Date	Topic
L1	Tue 8 Sep	Motion and speed
L2	Tue 15 Sep	Forces
L3	Tue 22 Sep	Energy
L4	Tue 29 Sep	Heat
L5	Tue 6 Oct	Waves and sound
L6	Tue 13 Oct	Light
L7	Tue 20 Oct	Electricity at home
L8	Tue 27 Oct	Magnets and motors